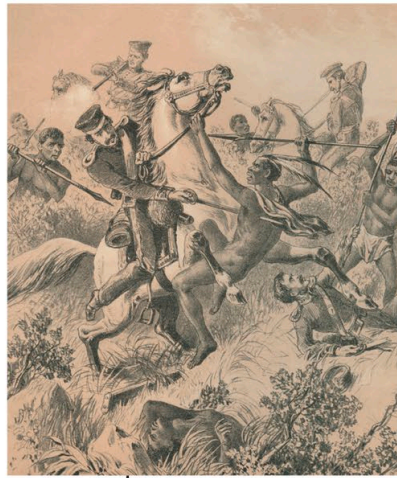


▷ Flintlock pistol



1779

XHOSA WARS BEGIN

From 1779 to 1879, European settlers in South Africa's Eastern Cape were embroiled in a series of nine wars involving the Xhosa Kingdom that arose from tensions between Xhosa chiefs, or between settlers and the Xhosa. The first war (1779-1810) arose from Boer allegations that the Xhosa were stealing cattle.

◁ A colonial depiction of the Xhosa Wars

1781 William Herschel
discovers Uranus, the
first planet found since
ancient times

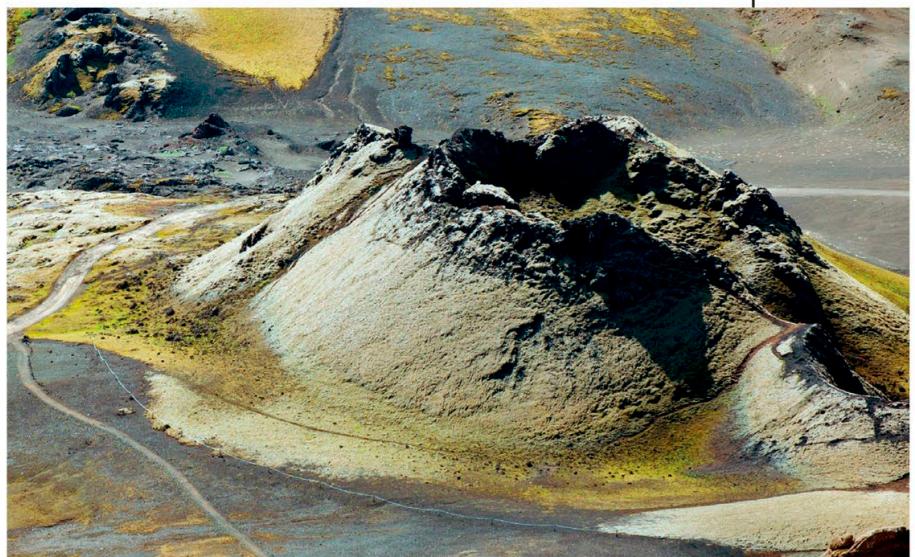
1782 Rama I of Siam
founds the Chakri
Dynasty, which still
rules Thailand

1784

1776 Adam Smith publishes
The Wealth of Nations, which
lays the foundations of modern
Western capitalism

1783
LAKI VOLCANO IN ICELAND ERUPTS

The Laki eruption was the greatest seen in historical times. For nearly one year (June 1783 to February 1784), the volcano spewed out lava, which spread over about 565 sq km (220 sq miles). The gases released caused a haze that reached Syria, western Siberia, and North Africa, and killed most of Iceland's domestic animals. In the ensuing famine, one-fifth of Iceland's population died.



△ The Laki crater, part of the Lakagígar fissure in Iceland

“It began with the Earth... splitting asunder, ripping and tearing as if a crazed animal were tearing something apart.”

ACCOUNT OF THE LAKI ERUPTION BY PASTOR JÓN STEINGRÍMSSON, 1783